Argument Against Bond Measure L

BOND DEBT IS NOT A LONG-TERM SOLUTION
School bonds are like credit cards. The repairs are charged today, but you repay the debt with interest at unknown rates over 30 years. Using a credit card for regular maintenance and long-term improvements, is reckless.

WHAT WILL YOU PAY IF MEASURE L passes?
NMCUSD's own projections show combined tax rates reaching $65 per $100,000 in 2029 and remaining above $50 through 2044.The past 12-year average tax rate has been $58.55 per $100,000.
When costs to landlords, apartment owners, and businesses go up, they are often passed on to tenants and consumers.

TRUST IS EARNED: NMCUSD doesn't guarantee **any** project will be completed.
That disclaimer is stated on the district website. Past experience demonstrates that:

1. Measure E (2002) promised a middle school. **It was never built.**
2. Measure H (2013) authorized $23.8M for projects that **appear again in Measure L.**

THE SOLUTION
When money is tight, responsible leaders make hard choices and stretch every dollar. NMCUSD should prioritize maintenance within its existing budget, pursue matching grants, fundraise, and save for major improvements. More than $120,000 in documented catering expenditures during one school year raises legitimate questions about spending priorities. Beyond bond, state, and federal funding, Monterey County School receive 61% of local property-tax revenue.

WHAT'S THE REAL PROBLEM?
The MCOE letter to the District dated 04/20/2026, re: State mandated Williams Act Report: **"no findings"** of facility conditions posing an emergency or urgent threat to student health or safety.

CLASSROOM INSTRUCTION SHOULD COME FIRST
Bond funds cannot pay teacher salaries, instructional programs, or ordinary operating expenses. Despite spending approximately $23,000 per student annually, only 7.2% of incoming ninth graders were proficient in math and 26.3% in reading.

VOTE NO ON MEASURE L

The District must manage their annual budget, just like you do.

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2026 AUG 10 A 10:00
REGISTRAR OF VOTERS
COUNTY OF MONTEREY

APPENDIX D – Required Argument Signature Statement

A ballot argument shall not be accepted unless accompanied by the printed name and signature or printed names and signatures of the person or persons submitting it, or, if submitted on behalf of an organization, the name of the organization and the printed name and signature of at least one of its principal officers (Elections Code §§9164, 9283, 9501.5).

No more than five signatures shall appear with any argument submitted under this article. In case any argument is signed by more than five persons, the signatures of the first five shall be printed (Elections Code §§9164, 9283, 9501.5).

All arguments concerning measures filed pursuant to this division shall be accompanied by the following form statement, to be ***signed by each proponent*** of the argument (Elections Code §9600):

"The undersigned proponent(s) or signer(s) of the:

☐ Primary argument in favor ☑ Primary argument against
☐ Rebuttal to argument in favor ☐ Rebuttal to argument against

ballot measure *(insert letter)* L at the ☐ Primary ☑ General ☐ Special

election for the North Monterey County Unified School District
(jurisdiction – name of district)

to be held on November 3, 2026 hereby state that this argument is true and
(Election date)

correct to the best of his/her/their knowledge and belief."

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COUNTY OF MONTEREY

Signatures of proponents (in order of appearance in the voter information guide):

(1) Printed Name Becky Gong Title (one) Certified Gov. Finance Manager
Signature _____ Date (Retired)08/05/2026

(2) Printed Name Kimberly Burdett Title (one) Bookkeeper
Signature _____ Date 08/05/2026

(3) Printed Name ~~Jim~~ Somerville Title (one) Realtor
Signature _____ Date 08/05/2026

(4) Printed Name Dr. Tonya ~~Blakesmore~~ Blakemore Tko Title (one) Pediatric Physician
Signature _____ Date 08/05/2026

(5) Printed Name Dr. Martha Carswell Title (one) Psychology PhD
Signature _____ Date 08/05/2026

Filer:

(1) Printed Name Rosemarie Barnard Title (one) North Monterey County Property Owner
Signature _____ Date 08/05/2026

Primary Contact Information: _____